

Annual Report 2025

UN Women Kenya



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Acronyms and Abbreviations

AGCCI	African Girls Can Code Initiative
AI	Artificial Intelligence
ASAL	Arid and Semi Arid Lands
AWP	Annual Work Plan
BPfA	Beijing Platform for Action
CCA	Common Country Analysis
CEDAW	Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women
CGEP	Country Gender Equality Profile
CoE	Centre of Excellence
CP	Country Programme
CSO	Civil Society Organization
CSW	Commission on the Status of Women
CSW69	Sixty Ninth Session of the Commission on the Status of Women
CRVS	Civil Registration and Vital Statistics
DIP	Disability Inclusion Strategy
DRR	Disaster Risk Reduction
EVAWG	Ending Violence Against Women and Girls
FGM	Female Genital Mutilation
FY	Financial Year
GBV	Gender Based Violence
GEM	Gender Equality Marker
GEWE	Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women
GoK	Government of Kenya
HR	Human Resources
ICT	Information and Communications Technology
IDP	Internally Displaced Person
ILO	International Labour Organization
IP	Implementing Partner
JP	Joint Programme
KNAP	Kenya National Action Plan on Women, Peace and Security
KNAP III	Kenya National Action Plan III on Women, Peace and Security (2025–2029)
KNBS	Kenya National Bureau of Statistics
KIHBS	Kenya Integrated Household Budget Survey
KMDHS	Kenya Mini Demographic and Health Survey
KSDS II	Kenya Strategy for the Development of Statistics II (2024–2028)
M&E	Monitoring and Evaluation

MEL – Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning

MTP IV – Fourth Medium Term Plan of Kenya Vision 2030

NAP – National Action Plan

NGEC – National Gender and Equality Commission

NSO – National Statistics Office

ODA – Official Development Assistance

OOSC – Out of School Children

PFM – Public Financial Management

PWDs – Persons with Disabilities

RC – Resident Coordinator

RCO – Resident Coordinator's Office

SDG – Sustainable Development Goal

SDG 5 – United Nations goal to Achieve Gender Equality and Empower All Women and Girls

SDG 8 – United Nations goal to Promote Sustained, Inclusive and Sustainable Economic

Growth, Full and Productive Employment and Decent Work for All

SGBV – Sexual and Gender Based Violence

STEM – Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics

SWAP – System Wide Action Plan

ToC – Theory of Change

TWG – Technical Working Group

UN – United Nations

UNCT – United Nations Country Team

UNCT SWAP – United Nations Country Team System Wide Action Plan for Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women

UNDG – United Nations Development Group

UNDP – United Nations Development Programme

UNGA – United Nations General Assembly

UNGA80 – Eightieth Session of the United Nations General Assembly

UNICEF – United Nations Children's Fund

UNSCR 1325 – United Nations Security Council Resolution 1325 on Women, Peace and Security

UNSDCF – United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Framework

UPR – Universal Periodic Review

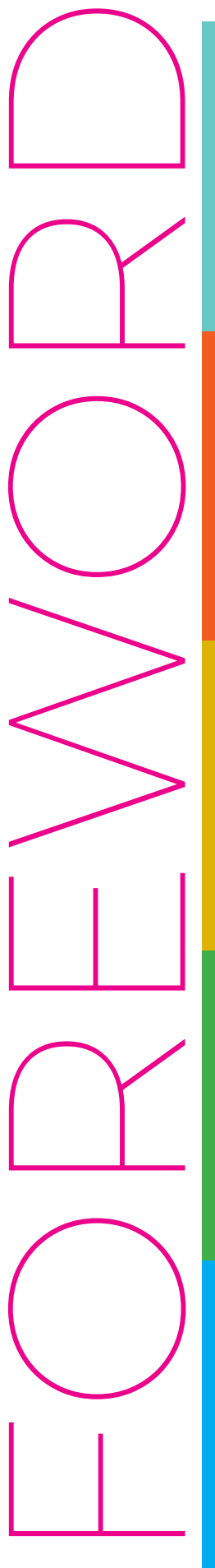
USD – United States Dollar

VAWG – Violence Against Women and Girls

VNR – Voluntary National Review

WEE – Women's Economic Empowerment

WPS – Women, Peace and Security



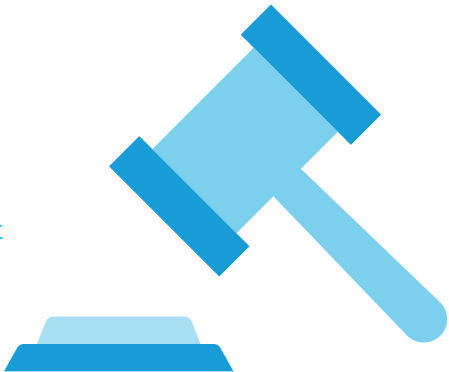
The year 2025 unfolded against a backdrop of tightening fiscal space, declining donor aid, and compounding global and national pressures that continue to test the pace and resilience of progress on gender equality. Across the development landscape, traditional financing for social sectors has contracted, humanitarian needs have intensified, and hard choices are being made about where limited resources are deployed. In this context, sustaining momentum on gender equality and women’s empowerment in Kenya has required sharper prioritization, stronger national ownership, and clearer evidence of impact.

At the same time, the implications of recent gains are unmistakable. Kenya has moved beyond episodic commitments toward a more consolidated normative and institutional

architecture for gender equality. Gender equality is no longer framed solely as a social imperative, but increasingly as a core pillar of economic governance, productivity, and resilience. These gains matter profoundly in an era of reduced donor aid, as they anchor gender equality commitments within national planning, budgeting, and accountability systems that can endure beyond external financing cycles. This reporting period showed that progress remains possible even under constrained conditions.

UN Women supported the development and launch of [Kenya’s third National Action Plan on Women, Peace and Security, KNAP III \(2025 to 2029\)](#), strengthening accountability for UNSCR 1325 implementation, and contributed to integrating gender equality priorities into Kenya’s Universal Periodic Review submissions. Advances in gender statistics, public procurement for women owned enterprises, survivor-centered justice responses, and devolved governance are strengthening foundations for scaled implementation, shaping how resources are allocated, services reach women and girls, and accountability is exercised across national and county systems. Declining public allocations to gender institutions, persistent underinvestment, and uneven capacity across sectors threaten to slow or reverse gains if not addressed decisively.

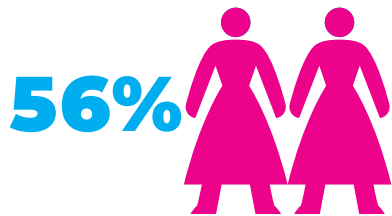
Landmark policy advances, such as Cabinet approval of the National Policy on Women’s Economic Empowerment and the parliamentary approval of the National Care Policy, signaled a decisive shift.



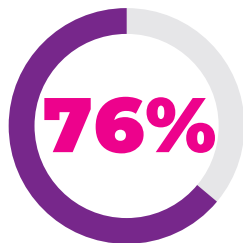
USD 21 million

allocated to gender equality and women's empowerment amounted to approximately representing about **0.08 percent** of the total national budget, highlighting continued underinvestment.

It estimated that GBV and femicide cost Kenya approximately **USD 264.5 million** annually, reframing femicide as both a human rights and economic development crisis.



UNSDCF indicators were gender-responsive.



UNSDCF indicators were gender-responsive, all reviewed Joint Programmes mainstreamed gender.

In 2025, government resources allocated to gender equality and women's empowerment amounted to approximately **USD 21 million**, representing about 0.08 percent of the total national budget, highlighting continued underinvestment.

Reduced donor aid heightens the urgency of demonstrating results at outcome level, strengthening monitoring and evaluation systems, and ensuring that gender equality investments deliver measurable economic and social returns. It also underscores the need for deeper integration of gender equality across United Nations coordination, national development frameworks, and financing strategies.

The safety, dignity, and economic empowerment of women are central to Kenya's development, yet femicide and severe gender-based violence continue to threaten these goals. In 2025, UN Women commissioned a [social analysis of femicide](#) to uncover the structural and normative drivers of extreme violence. The study revealed how entrenched patriarchal norms, harmful cultural practices, and weak legal enforcement systematically undermine women's economic security and autonomy.

Our coordination mandate remained central in 2025, with UN Women strengthening gender mainstreaming across the UN system in Kenya. Gender was integrated into the Common Country Analysis, **56 percent** of UNSDCF indicators were gender-responsive, all reviewed Joint Programmes mainstreamed gender, women comprised **53 percent** of UNCT leadership, and organizational culture scored **76 percent positive**. Through the Gender Parity Strategy and Country Gender Equality Profile, UN Women enhanced accountability, evidence-based programming, and institutional capacity across UN agencies.

Looking ahead, the task is clear. Progress must accelerate faster than the constraints that surround it. This requires consolidating recent normative advances, translating policies into financed and implemented action, and leveraging data, partnerships, and coordination to sustain impact. It requires positioning gender equality not as discretionary spending, but as a prerequisite for inclusive growth, peace, and sustainable development.

Antonia N.Gabala-Sodonon

UN Women Country Representative to Kenya

Key Results

Normative Results

In 2025, UN Women Kenya Country Office consolidated its role as a strategic enabler of normative change by translating global gender equality commitments into nationally owned policy frameworks, planning instruments, accountability mechanisms and financing pathways. UN Women Kenya advanced the localization and institutionalization of the **Beijing plus 30 Action Agenda, CEDAW, the Maputo Protocol, the Sustainable Development Goals, UNSCR 1325 and the Care Economy agenda**, moving engagement beyond consultation toward policy consolidation, inter institutional coordination and sustainable implementation.

At the policy and governance level, sustained technical engagement with the State Department for Gender and Affirmative Action supported Kenya to articulate and prioritize national commitments under **Beijing plus 30, CEDAW and the Maputo Protocol**. This resulted in the timely submission of an evidence-based Beijing plus 30 country position paper to CSW69, responses to the CEDAW ninth periodic review, and a national Beijing plus 30 commitments on Freedom from Poverty¹ ahead of UNGA80. Kenya was thereby positioned among countries globally advancing renewed political commitments to gender equality.

Under the Women Peace and Security agenda, UN Women provided financial and technical leadership in the development of **Kenya National Action Plan III on UNSCR 1325 for 2025 to 2029**². The Plan embeds gender-responsive peacebuilding within devolved governance systems and addresses emerging risks including climate related insecurity, displacement, economic fragility and online violence, while strengthening women's participation in peacebuilding, humanitarian action and recovery.

Beyond policy formulation, UN Women Kenya contributed to a historic institutional shift in addressing structural barriers to gender equality through Cabinet approval of the **National Policy on Women's Economic Empowerment**³ and the **National Care Policy**⁴. Together, these complementary frameworks advance women's economic empowerment while formally positioning unpaid care and domestic work as a national development and economic priority.

Equal Is Greater Documentary: The Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action at 30



Photo: UN Women/Kenya

Source: UN Women Africa. 2025. "Equal Is Greater Documentary: The Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action at 30." 2025 May.

 <https://youtu.be/-kOHtxuiwgQ?si=v4FhEnV3V5IXaOkk>

The Care Policy's integration into Kenya Medium Term Plan IV institutionalized care as a core socio economic priority, strengthening public sector ownership of care indicators, financing pathways and monitoring systems.

1. <https://www.unwomen.org/sites/default/files/2025-09/Brief-Beijing-30-Action-2-Freedom-from-poverty-en.pdf>
2. <https://africa.unwomen.org/en/digital-library/publications/2025/10/kenya-national-action-plan-2025-2029#view>
3. <https://www.capitalfm.co.ke/news/2025/03/cabinet-approves-national-policy-on-womens-economic-empowerment/>
4. <https://nation.africa/kenya/news/gender/what-kenya-s-ion-of-national-care-policy-means-for-gender-equality-5308780>

The Women's Economic Empowerment Policy provides a comprehensive roadmap to expand women's access to finance, markets, leadership and public procurement, while the Care Policy operationalizes the 5Rs framework to recognize, reduce, redistribute, and represent care work as a key driver of women's time poverty and economic exclusion.

Across planning and accountability processes, six⁵ gender equality commitments were integrated into national development strategies, UN coordination mechanisms and intergovernmental reporting. Through high level convenings and global engagement around CSW69, UNGA80 and the UPR, Kenya shifted from passive compliance to active normative leadership. Collectively, these results strengthened Kenya national normative environment, enhanced UN system coherence and created durable foundations for financing and implementation of gender equality commitments.

Contribution of UN Women: UN Women led the technical preparation and clearance of Kenya's evidence-based Beijing plus 30 country position paper for CSW69, supported government responses to the CEDAW ninth periodic review, and facilitated the articulation of Kenya's national Beijing plus 30 commitments on Freedom from Poverty ahead of UNGA80. UN Women provided hands on technical leadership to the formulation of KNAP III, ensuring its alignment with devolved governance, emerging security risks and gender-responsive peacebuilding priorities.

Coordination Results

The 2025 United Nations Country Team System-Wide Action Plan (UNCT-SWAP) assessment showed strong progress in gender mainstreaming across the UN system in Kenya. Indicators on Common Country Analysis, Engagement with Government, and Gender Parity exceeded minimum requirements, while indicators on United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Framework (UNSDCF) monitoring and evaluation and Gender Results met minimum requirements. Overall, eleven of the fifteen United Nations Country Team (UNCT) Performance Indicators were scored as exceeding minimum requirements, four met minimum requirements, and one was assessed as approaching minimum requirement.

In parallel, UN Women supported the UN Country Team to strengthen system-wide gender analysis and accountability through operationalization of the Gender Parity Strategy^[1] for the UN system in Kenya. Through engagements with the Human Resource Working Group and the Gender Theme Group, UN Women contributed to improved alignment, shared understanding, and commitment to gender parity objectives across agencies.

Kenya's Story in Global Spotlight: UN Women's Coordination Efforts



Photo: UN Women/Kenya

Source: UN Women Africa. 2025. "Kenya's Story in Global Spotlight: UN Women's Coordination and Planning Efforts." 30 April

 https://youtu.be/NFgxpV7p19s?si=inP3jrQB2F-_o5s3

5. 1) women's safety, 2) prevention of gender-based violence and femicide, 3) elimination of harmful cultural practices, 4) access to justice, 5) economic empowerment, and 6) promotion of women's autonomy and participation in social and economic life.

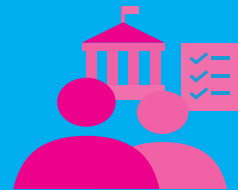
Capacity strengthening and deployment of localized data collection tools enhanced the UN system’s ability to track progress, identify gaps, and implement corrective actions under the **Gender Parity Strategy 2024 to 2028^[2]**.

UN Women continued to strengthen operational and convening capacity of UN Kenya to deliver development mandates. To ensure effective coordination and facilitation for all UN Agencies, UN Women Kenya demonstrated strong synergies across its triple mandate, normative support, UN system coordination, and operational activities, by strengthening gender mainstreaming across the UNSDCF and reinforcing collective accountability through the UNCT-SWAP Gender Equality Scorecard. Under its normative mandate, UN Women developed and disseminated the Country Gender Equality Profile (CGEP) sectoral briefs across ten thematic areas, providing an evidence-based gender analysis aligned with global frameworks such as CEDAW and the Beijing Platform for Action.

The CGEP findings were actively used to inform the inter-agency Common Country Analysis (CCA) Light Review, ensuring that gender equality was embedded in the UN's core strategic assessment. The CGEP also served as the primary evidence base during Joint Programme review clinics, strengthening programme logic, gender-responsive outputs, and indicators. In addition, the CGEP informed collective accountability processes under the UNCT-SWAP Gender Equality Scorecard, contributing to improved performance in planning and programming dimensions.

The Strategy established a shared national framework and evidence base for male engagement, clarifying concepts and addressing persistent misconceptions that undermine effective programming. By grounding male engagement in credible national data and linking it to social cohesion, GBV prevention and peaceful coexistence, the Strategy strengthened the policy and programmatic foundation for inclusive gender equality efforts. This outcome positions government institutions to advance a forthcoming Policy on Male Engagement and Inclusion and to support longer term evidence generation on masculinities and transformative change in Kenya. As a result of this national male engagement and inclusion strategy, there has been increased involvement, sensitization, awareness and deliberate effort to reach out to men and boys as allies in the gender equality landscape.

56 percent of UNSDCF indicators are gender-responsive, with all 16 reviewed Joint Programmes mainstreaming gender, including six achieving GEM 3. This adoption at the UNCT system enabled alignment of programming with gender commitments and informed **USD 12 million towards gender-responsive Joint Programmes**.



UN Women Kenya demonstrated strong synergies across its triple mandate, normative support, UN system coordination, and operational activities, by strengthening gender mainstreaming across the UNSDCF.

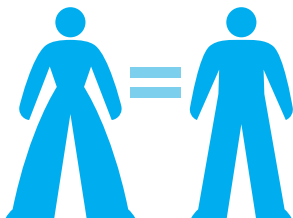


On Male engagement, UN Women Kenya contributed to enhanced national institutional capacity to engage men and boys in advancing gender equality through its technical support to the development and implementation of the National Male Engagement and Inclusion Strategy, signed in August 2025.

Leadership and accountability were reinforced, with gender discussed in over **60 percent of UNCT meetings**, women comprising **53 percent** of UNCT leadership, and organizational culture scoring **76 percent positive**. Despite this progress, limited evidence of outcome level GEWE results remains a key gap, underscoring the need for stronger monitoring and evaluation systems and more consistent use of sex-disaggregated data.

To address the gap in demonstrating outcome level gender equality and women’s empowerment results, UN Women supported the implementation of the 2025 UNCT Gender Equality Scorecard Action Plan and the annual UNCT SWAP assessment. The UNCT Gender Scorecard, endorsed by United Nations Development Group (UNDG) in response to the Chief Executives Board Policy on Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women, provides a structured mechanism for assessing performance, identifying gaps, and driving corrective actions to strengthen comprehensive gender mainstreaming across the UNSDCF 2022 to 2026, including in UNCT policies, programming, and business operations.

Contribution of UN Women: UN Women’s specific contribution in 2025 was to act as the technical driver and accountability anchor for gender mainstreaming across UNCT Joint Programmes in Kenya. UN Women coordinated and delivered targeted interagency capacity strengthening on the Gender Equality Marker, joint programme gender checklists, gender analysis, and gender-responsive monitoring, evaluation and reporting, working closely with the Resident Coordinator’s Office, the Gender Theme Group and the MEL Group.



This technical support directly enabled Joint Programmes to apply GEM 1 to 3 consistently, align results with the UNSDCF gender architecture, and exceed the minimum threshold for gender-responsive indicators.

Operational Results

1. Women Leadership and Decision Making

1.1. Devolution and National Planning

Public financing for gender equality and women’s empowerment remained constrained in 2025. Allocations to the State Department for Gender and Affirmative Action and the National Gender and Equality Commission continued a downward trend, remaining below **0.2 percent of the national budget**. This persistent underinvestment underscores structural limitations in translating policy commitments into adequate fiscal prioritization for gender equality outcomes.

In 2025, UN Women continued to strengthen devolution and national planning for gender equality and women empowerment by advancing inclusive, accountable and rights-based governance through the [SDG Localization Programme](#) across eight counties⁶. These processes strengthened transparency, enhanced sub-county accountability and shifted participation from ad hoc consultations toward more institutionalized, rights-based systems, contributing to more equitable resource allocation and improved service delivery outcomes.

Inclusive public participation emerged as a key driver of SDG localization. In counties including **Narok, Kitui, Kwale and Homa Bay**, structured and inclusive engagement mechanisms enabled women, youth and organizations of persons with disabilities to influence county planning processes and **FY 2025/26 budgets**.

6. West Pokot, Kitui, Kwale, Wajir, Narok, Embu, Samburu and Homa Bay

Accelerating Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) through Localization – Kenya



Photo: UN Women/Kenya

When the community members of Imbo village gather at their local borehole, there is laughter, conversation and a shared sense of ownership. Not long ago, clean water was a distant dream. Today, a community-managed borehole, supported through county planning, has brought relief to over 500 families.

“We used to walk for hours every day to fetch water,” recalls Mary (name changed for privacy) a member of the Ochina Water Project, “Now we have time to work, rest, and even attend public meetings. For the first time, I feel my voice matters in how our county develops.”

Mary’s story mirrors a growing shift in Homa Bay County, where women, youth, and marginalized groups are stepping into decision-making spaces, and helping to shape county plans, budgets, and priorities. For years, structural barriers and limited participation kept citizens at the margins of governance. But under Kenya’s Public Finance Management Act (2012) and Constitution (2010), counties are mandated to involve the public in planning and budgeting.

With support from the United Nations Joint Programme on SDG Localization, led by UN Women, UNICEF, and UNDP, Homa Bay County stands out as a model for gender-responsive leadership and community participation.

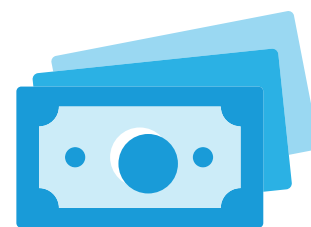
Source: UN Women Africa. 2025. “Accelerating Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) through Localization – Kenya.” 01 October.

 <https://africa.unwomen.org/en/stories/news/2025/10/accelerating-sustainable-development-goals-sdgs-through-localization-in-kenya>

 <https://youtu.be/otXNaFT1F0Q?si=CBiff7LPYsUcbyc4>

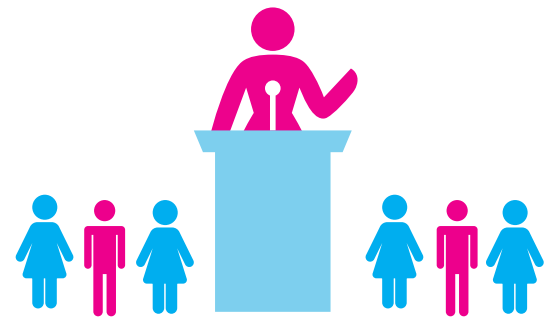
A significant innovation under the programme was the development and rollout of Kenya’s first gender-responsive SDG localization tracking tool. Implemented with county budget facilitators, the tool enables counties to assess alignment of programme-based budgets with priority SDG targets across social protection, health, education, gender equality, water, employment, climate action and governance. By adapting global indicators to local contexts, the tool strengthened evidence-based planning, accountability and SDG informed decision making at county level.

County budgets increasingly reflected SDG aligned priorities such as technical support strengthened sectoral analysis, informed budget memoranda and supported formal submission of citizen proposals to County Assemblies. Post budget reviews, adaptive use of alternative data sources where official estimates were delayed, and emerging electronic monitoring dashboards signal growing institutionalization of SDG monitoring and accountability within devolved governance systems.



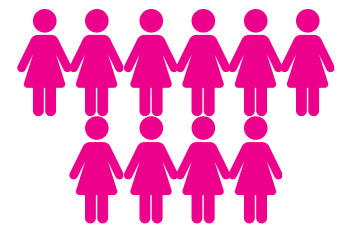
County budgets increasingly reflected SDG aligned priorities such as technical support strengthened sectoral analysis, informed budget memoranda.

Contribution of UN Women: The above results were achieved through collaboration with United Nations Development Programme and United Nations Children’s Fund, combining technical assistance, capacity strengthening and multi actor partnerships to advance inclusive, gender-responsive and sustainable development at national and county levels. UN Women’s specific contribution in 2025 was to provide the technical leadership on gender-responsive planning, results-based reporting and convening support that enabled counties to operationalize gender-responsive SDG localization within devolved planning and budgeting systems and mechanisms.



1.2 Gender Data and Statistics

In 2025, Kenya achieved significant results in strengthening the production and use of gender data and statistics as a foundation for evidence-based policymaking, accountability and SDG monitoring, with gender data shifting from a technical niche to a central driver of national planning and economic discourse. Two national frameworks consolidated these gains. Together, these frameworks institutionalized sex-disaggregated data across sectors, clarified institutional roles, and formally integrated Citizen Generated Data in line with the Copenhagen Framework, strengthening SDG monitoring and Voluntary National Review reporting.



The Gender Sector Statistics Plan II 2024–2028 was validated and embedded within the Kenya Strategy for the Development of Statistics II 2024–2028⁷, establishing a coherent national architecture for the production, coordination and use of gender statistics.

Concrete improvements were recorded in the national data systems and products. Gender perspectives were integrated into flagship surveys, including the Kenya Integrated Household Budget Survey , the Kenya Mini Demographic and Health Survey⁸, and the Integrated Labor Force Survey⁹ with a Time Use Survey module¹⁰. These instruments will generate new and expanded indicators on unpaid domestic and care work, technologically facilitated gender-based violence, femicide, early childhood development, labourforce participation and other time use patterns, strengthening measurement of SDG 5 and SDG 8 targets. Gender analysis was elevated within national economic reporting.



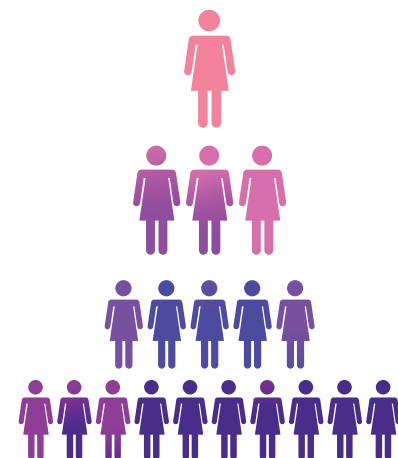
Evidence generation was further advanced through publication of the Women Empowerment Report – Developing a Measure and the [Economic Value of Unpaid Domestic and Care Work Report](#), which aimed at better understanding of the situation of women in Kenya and quantified the economic value of unpaid domestic and care work and directly informed implementation of the National Care Policy and Women’s Economic Empowerment Policy, respectively.

The Kenya Economic Survey 2025 incorporated a dedicated Social and Economic Inclusion chapter and expanded sex-disaggregated sectoral statistics, strengthening visibility of women’s and men’s participation across the economy and government investments targeting women, youth and persons with disabilities.

7. <https://www.knbs.or.ke/wp-content/uploads/2025/07/The-Second-Kenya-Strategy-for-Development-of-Statistics.pdf>
8. <https://www.knbs.or.ke/2025-26-kenya-integrated-household-budget-survey-kihbs/>
9. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_Fj02oNUgsl
10. <https://www.knbs.or.ke/2025-remittances-household-survey-2025-rhs/>

Governance and coordination of gender statistics improved through functional inter agency platforms, including the Inter Agency Gender Statistics Technical Committee and the Civil Registration and Vital Statistics Technical Working Group, which enabled regular review of progress, methodological alignment and validation of national gender statistics priorities and products.

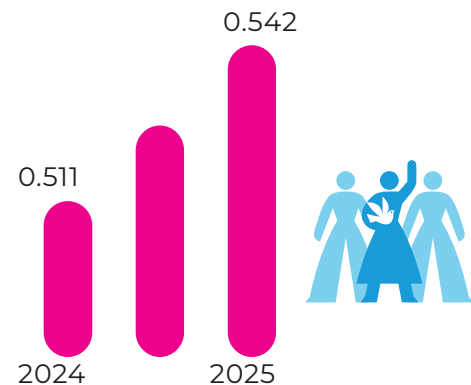
Contribution of UN Women: In 2025, UN Women supported Kenya to strengthen its statistical processes through which gender statistics are planned, produced, and used across the national statistical system. This focused on aligning gender statistics frameworks within the broader national data ecosystem, embedding gender considerations into the routine design and rollout of major national surveys and censuses, and strengthening integration of gender analysis in official economic reporting. Further, UN Women supported national coordination mechanisms and user-producer dialogues among key institutions responsible for producing official statistics and administrative data. This will ensure shared priorities, consistency in approaches, and sustained national attention to gender data for policy formulation and accountability.



This focused on aligning gender statistics frameworks within the broader national data ecosystem, embedding gender considerations into the routine design and rollout of major national surveys and censuses.

2. Women, Peace, Security and Humanitarian Action

In 2025, Kenya recorded incremental progress on the Women, Peace and Security agenda, with its WPS Index score improving from **0.511 in 2024 to 0.542 in 2025** reflecting modest gains in women’s inclusion, justice and security. This trajectory highlights both progress and persistent gaps that require sustained national action. UN Women Kenya strengthened national accountability and institutional commitment to the Women, Peace and Security agenda through the successful development, validation and official launch of **Kenya’s Third National Action Plan on UNSCR 1325 (KNAP III) for 2025–2029**¹¹. The adoption of KNAP III represents a significant national result, consolidating Kenya’s longstanding engagement with the WPS agenda into a renewed, government owned and results oriented framework.



Kenya recorded incremental progress on the Women, Peace and Security agenda, with its WPS Index score improving from 0.511 in 2024 to 0.542 in 2025.

11. Ibid 2

25 Years of UNSCR 1325: Advancing Kenya's Women, Peace, and Security Agenda



Photo: UN Women/Kenya

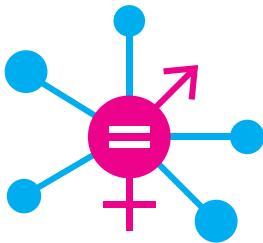
Source: UN Women Africa. 2025. “25 Years of UNSCR 1325: Advancing Kenya’s Women, Peace, and Security Agenda .” 18 December.

 https://youtu.be/P3h9UpWcsgU?si=Gw0ASQOtBudr_cdu

KNAP III positions women’s participation as central to peacebuilding, conflict prevention, humanitarian action, and recovery, while expanding national **WPS** priorities to address emerging and intersecting risks, including electoral and climate-related insecurity, displacement, economic vulnerability, and gender-based violence including online violence. The Plan strengthens protection of women’s rights and leadership in peace and security governance and embeds gender-responsive peacebuilding within national and devolved systems.

Contribution of UN Women: UN Women strengthened government technical capacity on gender and the Women, Peace and Security agenda by supporting inclusive review, drafting, and validation processes for Kenya’s Third National Action Plan on UNSCR 1325 for 2025 to 2029. UN Women provided technical support to government institutions including the Ministry of Gender, Culture and Children Services and the Ministry of Interior and National Administration to assess progress under previous action plans, update national priorities, and apply gender-responsive analysis to peace and security policies, ensuring stronger integration of women’s participation, protection, and leadership.

KNAP III enhances alignment across government institutions, civil society and partners, provides a basis for coordinated financing and implementation, and reinforces accountability for measurable outcomes on women’s participation, protection and resilience, positioning the country to accelerate progress toward inclusive and sustainable peace.



UN Women supported government institutions, including the Ministry of Gender, Culture and Children Services and the Ministry of Interior and National Administration, in assessing progress.

3. Elimination of Violence against Women and Girls

In 2025, Kenya made progress in advancing laws and policies to end violence against women and girls, strengthening the legal and policy environment to respond to GBV and femicide. UN Women's technical, convening, and advisory support enhanced the capacity of justice sector institutions to draft and analyze gender-responsive legislation, contributed to the refinement of the Draft Sexual Offences Amendment Bill¹² now ready for public participation, and informed evidence-based discussions on family and personal laws, laying a foundation for more effective protection of women and girls.

In 2025, UN Women contributed to efforts addressing femicide and severe gender based violence, supporting strengthened evidence and justice system response. A social analysis of femicide, conducted with technical support from UN Women, used legal reviews, police and judicial records, and interviews with survivors, families, civil society, and justice actors. The study revealed how entrenched patriarchal norms and harmful practices—including child marriage, FGM, bride price, wife inheritance, and property dispossession—combine with weak legal enforcement to undermine women's security, economic participation, and autonomy. National SGBV reporting shows **31,460** cases filed and **31,880 concluded**, achieving a **101 percent case clearance** rate¹³, while in six focus counties¹⁴ **6,490 cases were reported**. The analysis estimated that GBV and femicide cost Kenya approximately **USD 264 million** annually, reframing femicide as both a human rights and economic development challenge. These findings have informed legal and policy reforms, strengthened referral pathways, and enhanced justice sector capacity to respond effectively to survivors, laying the foundation for more targeted interventions and evidence-based advocacy.

Over the reporting period, national SGBV reporting and case resolution trends indicate strengthened justice system throughput and survivor engagement. A total of **31,460 SGBV cases** were filed nationally, compared to **31,176** the previous year, while the Judiciary concluded **31,880 cases**, achieving a 101 percent case clearance rate¹⁵.



Significant strides were made through the review of four priority legal frameworks: the **Sexual Offences Act, Marriage Act, Matrimonial Property Act, and Law of Succession Act**.



31,460 National SGBV case reporting



31,880 Cases concluded



101% Case clearance



In **six counties**¹⁶ that UN Women has focused on, **6,490 cases** were reported, with **Nairobi, Bungoma and Kisumu** recording the highest caseloads. These patterns reflect increased awareness of reporting mechanisms and referral pathways, together with growing confidence in the justice system's ability to process cases.

12. <https://www.parliament.go.ke/sites/default/files/2025-12/THE%20SEXUAL%20OFFENCES%20%28AMENDMENT%29%20BILL%2C2025.pdf>
13. <https://judiciary.go.ke/sojar-2024-to-2025/>
14. Bungoma, Vihiga, Kisumu, Nairobi, Isiolo and Kilifi
15. <https://judiciary.go.ke/sojar-2024-to-2025/>
16. Bungoma, Vihiga, Kisumu, Nairobi, Isiolo and Kilifi

Dreams on hold: How Teenage Pregnancy, HIV, and Gender-based Violence are Stealing Girls' Futures



Photo: UN Women/Kenya

In Kenya, thousands of girls are losing their futures to the “triple threat” of teenage pregnancy, HIV infection, and gender-based violence (GBV). Combined, these three challenges are a disruptor to education, a driver of poverty, and keep many young women repeating cycles of trauma and disadvantage.

Kajiado County is at the epicentre of this crisis, silently eroding the futures of its girls and young women. The combination is lethal: girls pushed into sexual exploitation or early marriages face pregnancies that end their education, while lack of information and power leaves them vulnerable to HIV. For many, this is not just a statistic; it is a stolen childhood.

The problem is especially pronounced in the Majengo area, an informal settlement in Kajiado Central, where poverty, drug abuse, and harmful cultural practices fuel the cycle. Unless urgent interventions are scaled up, the county risks raising a generation of girls trapped in poverty, poor health, and trauma.

Source: UN Women Africa. 2025. “Dreams on hold: How teenage pregnancy, HIV, and gender-based violence are stealing girls' futures.” 01 October.

👉 <https://africa.unwomen.org/en/stories/news/2025/10/dreams-on-hold-how-teenage-pregnancy-hiv-and-gender-based-violence-are-stealing-girls-futures>



According to the Kenya Health Information System (KHIS), Kajiado continues to record among the highest numbers of teenage pregnancies and GBV cases in the country.

Justice sector performance and accountability showed tangible improvement. A total of **187 justice actors** demonstrated improved competencies in survivor-centered response, evidence handling and use of GBV data. Functionality improved in **12 Gender Justice Courts**, supported by practice directions gazetted in 2025 that standardized survivor-centered procedures. Accountability was further strengthened through adoption of requirements for prosecuting police perpetrated SGBV, improving access to justice and reinforcing standards within security institutions.

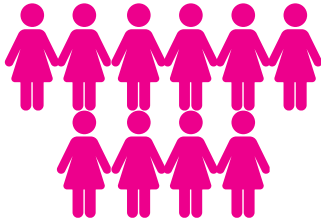
Availability and effectiveness of survivor-centered services expanded during the reporting period. Through the support of UN Women, **a total of 1,767 survivors** accessed legal and psychosocial support, with **93 percent** reporting satisfaction, indicating improved reach and service quality. Community level prevention and awareness initiatives reached **1,746 people**, supported by **93 community champions** advancing knowledge of survivor rights and referral pathways, contributing to strengthened community level prevention and access to support.

Economic recovery and agency among survivors increased alongside protection and justice interventions. In 2025, total of **204 survivors** supported by UN Women acquired vocational and financial skills, with **80 receiving grants** to initiate or expand income generating activities, supporting recovery and longer-term independence. Survivors also contributed directly to national policy processes through participation in the Technical Working Group on Femicide. Progress was recorded on priority legal reforms, development of a **Judiciary Benchbook on family and personal laws**, and evidence generation on femicide and technology facilitated GBV.

Consistency and quality of gender-responsive adjudication improved through judicial guidance and legal empowerment. Development of a **Family and Personal Laws Benchbook** supported more consistent interpretation of family and personal laws, embedded constitutional and human rights standards, and promoted survivor-centered and rights-based decision making¹⁷. Complementary support to women’s rights organizations expanded legal awareness and legal aid services, directly strengthening access to justice for women and girls facing discrimination and violence.



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17. The Benchbook is expected to be finalized in March 2026, following a request from the Judiciary to allow more time for comprehensive consultations.

Contribution of UN Women: UN Women strengthened national and subnational capacity to prevent and respond to sexual and gender-based violence by supporting justice sector institutions, service providers, and communities to apply survivor-centered, gender-responsive approaches across reporting, adjudication, and recovery processes. This included building the skills of justice actors to handle SGBV cases, strengthening the functionality of specialized gender justice mechanisms, and supporting coordination between police, prosecutors, courts, and service providers to improve case management and accountability. UN Women also supported systems for survivor access to legal, psychosocial, and economic recovery services, while reinforcing community-level prevention, referral pathways, and rights awareness.

These efforts were informed by evidence from the Femicide Analysis Report and findings of the Presidential Working Group on GBV, ensuring targeted, evidence-based interventions across the justice and service delivery continuum.

4. Women's Economic Empowerment

In 2025, Kenya recorded measurable progress in advancing women's economic empowerment through strengthened gender-responsive economic governance, expanded access to markets and procurement, and policy reforms that addressed structural barriers to women's participation in decent work. Women, girls and persons with disabilities increasingly accessed economic pathways that support resilience, sustainability and equity, contributing to more inclusive and climate responsive economic systems.

Gender equality was embedded more systematically across national economic and climate frameworks. **The National Gender and Climate Change Action Plan**¹⁸ positioned women's leadership differentiated climate risks and livelihood resilience in ASAL counties at the center of adaptation and mitigation priorities. The Disability Inclusion Strategy¹⁹ strengthened pathways to inclusive employment, entrepreneurship and access to services, addressing intersecting barriers faced by women and girls with disabilities and women caregivers.

A major structural shift was achieved through **Cabinet approval of the National Policy on Women's Economic Empowerment and the National Care Policy**. Together, these policies established a coherent national framework that expands women's access to finance, markets, entrepreneurship and public procurement, while formally recognizing unpaid care and domestic work as a binding constraint to women's economic participation.



Women, girls and persons with disabilities increasingly accessed economic pathways that support resilience, sustainability and equity.

18. <https://www.ngeckkenya.org/news/14316/ngec-champions-gender-responsive-climate-action-as-kenya-gears-up-for-cop29-and-launches-national-gender-and-climate-change-action-plan>

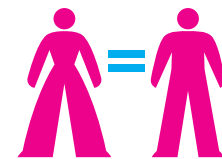
19. <https://ncpwd.go.ke/download/kenya-joint-disability-strategy-2025-2027-final-report/>

Integration of the care agenda into Kenya’s Medium-Term Plan IV institutionalized care as a development priority and strengthened accountability for care responsive investments. UN Women contributed to embedding disability inclusion within the National Care Policy, ensuring that gender analysis addresses the intersecting discrimination faced by women and girls with disabilities and establishes targeted, gender-responsive actions to advance inclusive participation and protection from gender-based violence, resulting in more accessible care services and support systems for persons with disabilities.

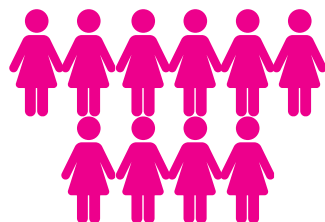
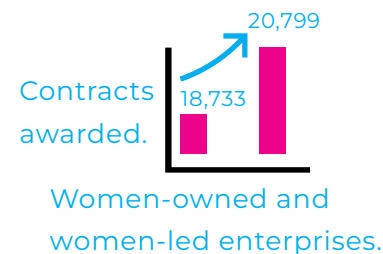
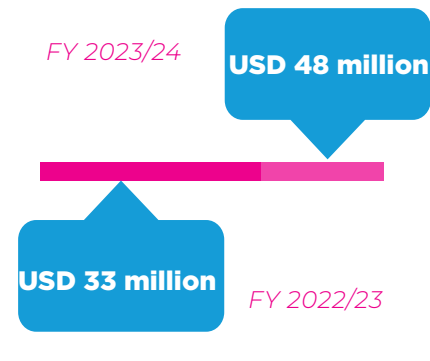
Increased understanding of care informed planning and budgeting contributed to growth in national allocations for women’s economic empowerment initiatives, rising from approximately **USD 33 million in FY 2022/23** to approximately **USD 48 million in FY 2023/24**²⁰.

Women’s access to markets expanded through more inclusive public procurement systems. Contracts awarded to women owned and women led enterprises increased **from 18,733 to 20,799**, while contract value rose from **USD 231 million to USD 256 million**²¹. Under the Access to Government Procurement Opportunities framework, targeted support to procurement systems resulted in a **58 percent** increase in contracts awarded to women owned enterprises and a **121 percent increase in earnings**²².

At county level, translation of national care commitments into budgetary action increased investments in care infrastructure and services, expanded access to water, and reduced women’s unpaid care burdens. Collectively, these results demonstrate progress toward a more inclusive, gender-responsive and resilient economic model that positions women as drivers of sustainable development.



Four national and multisectoral strategies integrated gender equality within economic growth, climate action and inclusion agendas.



At the enterprise level, **539 women owned** and women led businesses across ten counties, including ASAL counties, strengthened procurement readiness, business formalization and market access, improving income security and resilience to economic and climate shocks.

20. <https://www.knbs.or.ke/reports/2025-economic-survey/>

21. Ibid 16

22. Ibid 16



Photo: UN Women/Kenya

The Burden of Unpaid Care Work in Kenya

In the bustling, informal settlement landscapes of Nairobi, a silent and strenuous labour unfolds daily within countless homes. It is the unpaid care work carried out predominantly by women, a burden made heavier when a child requires specialized attention. Raising a child with a disability presents unique challenges, from the ongoing need for medication and therapy to the emotional and social isolation that often accompanies the journey. It is a story of immense strength, profound love, and a struggle against societal norms that devalue this labour and stigmatize those who perform it.

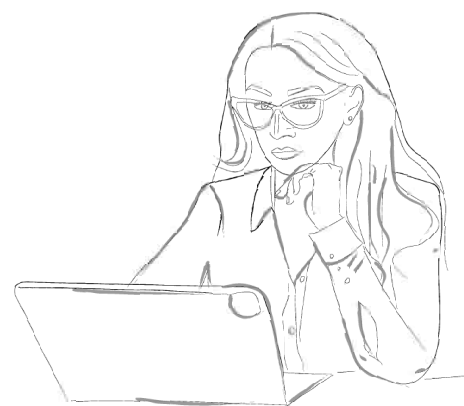
While unpaid care work is fundamental to a functioning society, it remains largely unrecognized in economic terms, perpetuating a cycle of poverty and dependence, especially for women in low-income areas. For mothers of children with disabilities, this care work is all-encompassing, demanding every waking moment and leaving little room for personal or professional pursuits. It is a relentless cycle of feeding, cleaning, therapy, and emotional support that often becomes a full-time job.

Source: UN Women Africa. 2025. "The Burden of Unpaid Care Work in Kenya." 02 October.

 <https://africa.unwomen.org/en/stories/feature-story/2025/10/the-burden-of-unpaid-care-work-in-kenya>

Complementarily, through the [African Girls Can Code Initiative \(AGCCI\)](#), UN Women addressed intersecting barriers for young women and adolescent girls related to gender, geography, disability, and socio-economic exclusion in STEM and the digital economy. The bootcamps covered coding, cybersecurity, AI, and more, deliberately reaching first-time coders and non-ICT majors. Participants like [Linnet Githii](#) gained skills leading to internships at Siemens and representation at international forums like Germany's Bürgerfest. AGCCI's model bridges systemic exclusion by providing tools, mentorship, and access, creating a pipeline of talent where previously there was none.

Beyond technical skills, AGCCI created mentorship-driven learning spaces that enhanced participants' confidence, leadership, and sense of belonging in male-dominated tech environments. Young women reported identifying as "coders," STEM leaders, and innovators, reversing internalized exclusion and enabling them to claim spaces previously denied.



UN Women expanded access to digital skills to **100 young women** from historically excluded counties, including Wajir, Mandera, Bomet, Kisumu, and Mombasa.

Empowered to Empower: How Ruth Osebe Michoma is Opening Procurement Doors for Women with Disabilities

In collaboration with the Government of Kenya, UN Women Kenya launched a [gender-responsive procurement \(GRP\) initiative under its Women's Economic Empowerment \(WEE\) programme in 2024](#). This flagship programme is generously funded by the United Arab Emirates (UAE) with \$15 million under the UAE-UN Women Strategic Partnership Framework 2024 –2027, and aims to accelerate gender equality and women's economic empowerment by increasing women's access to public and private procurement opportunities.

Through this partnership, UN Women and the UAE are working together to support women entrepreneurs, strengthen inclusive supply chains, and enhance sustainable livelihoods.

Ruth Osebe Michoma, a spirited entrepreneur living with disability, is redefining what resilience looks like in Kenya's business landscape. As the managing director of Rosebe Enterprises and Rosebe Agencies Limited, Ruth is one of the many women whose lives have been transformed through this initiative.



Photo: UN Women/Kenya

Source: UN Women Africa. 2025. "Empowered to Empower: How Ruth Osebe Michoma is Opening Procurement Doors for Women with Disabilities." 22 July.

 <https://africa.unwomen.org/en/stories/news/2025/09/empowered-to-empower-how-ruth-osebe-michoma-is-opening-procurement-doors-for-women-with-disabilities#:~:text=Ruth%20highlighted%20the%20silent%20barriers,in%20government%20payments%20among%20others.%20%C2%A0>

Contribution of UN Women: UN Women supported national and county institutions to strengthen gender-responsive economic governance by embedding gender equality and care considerations into economic, climate, and inclusion policy processes. This included technical and convening support to integrate gender across national strategies, advance policy reform on women's economic empowerment and unpaid care and align these commitments with planning and budgeting frameworks. UN Women also strengthened institutional capacity to operationalize inclusive procurement and market access systems, while supporting women owned enterprises to engage with public markets.



At sub-national level, UN Women supported counties to translate national care and economic commitments into budgeted actions and services, reinforcing systems that reduce unpaid care burdens and expand women's access to decent work, markets, and resilient livelihoods.

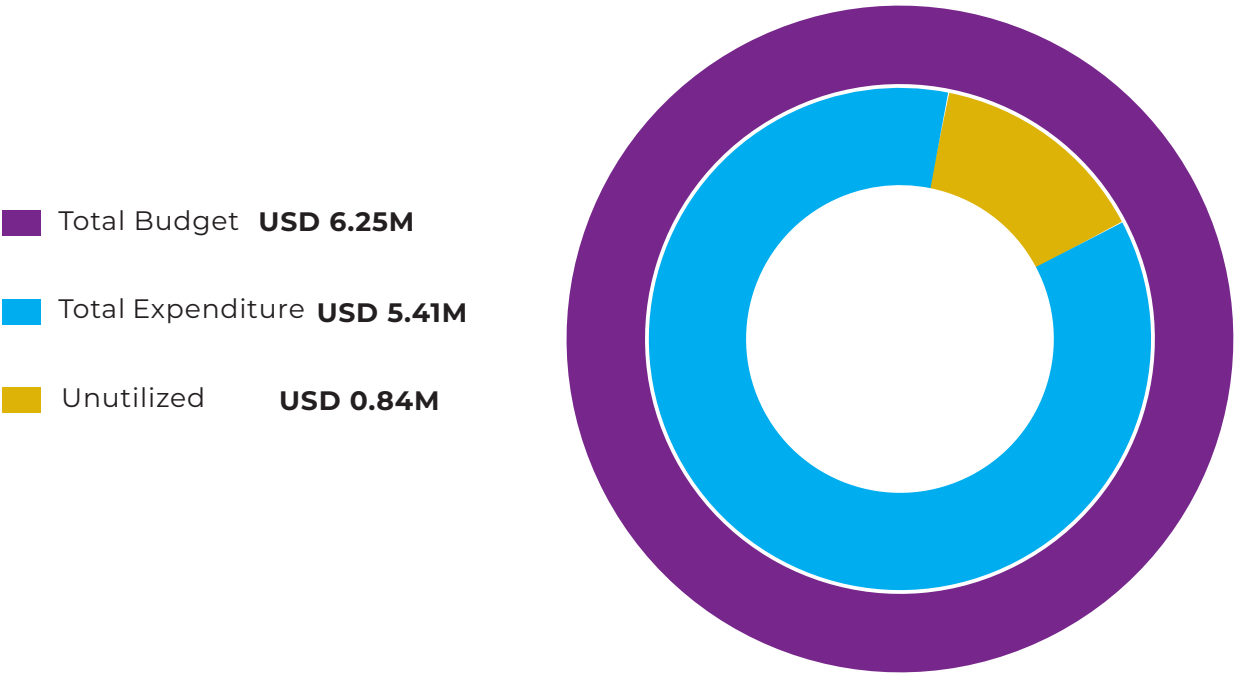
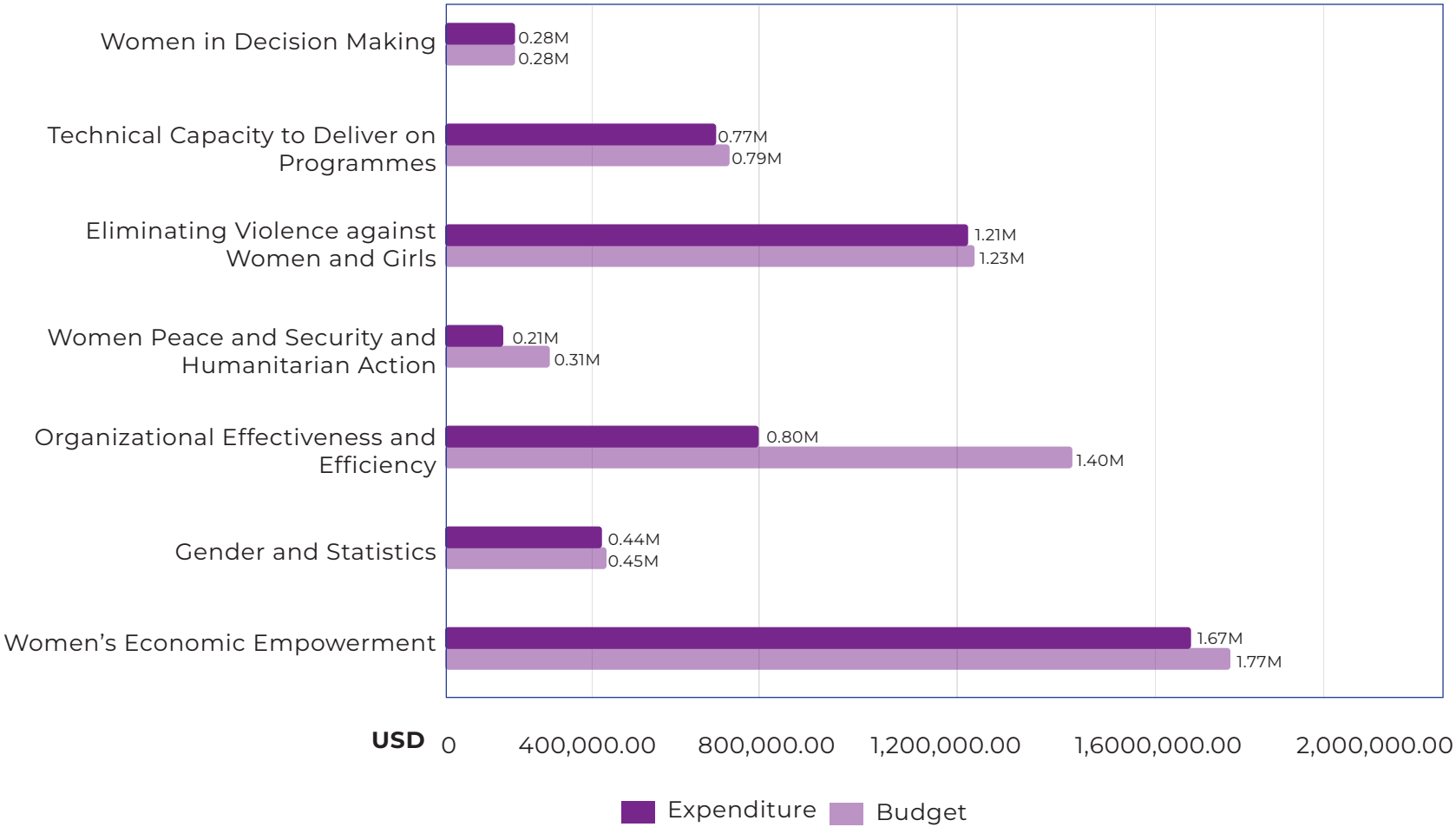


Photo: UN Women/Kenya

5. Lessons Learned

- ▶ **Normative commitments translate into real change only when they are anchored in national planning, financing, and accountability systems.** The 2025 experience shows that moving beyond consultation to embed global gender equality frameworks within Cabinet approved policies, medium term plans, monitoring frameworks, and inter-institutional coordination mechanisms is what shifts norms from political statements to implementable obligations. Localization through nationally owned policies such as KNAP III and the National Care Policy, alignment with planning and budgeting cycles, and linkage to financing pathways proved decisive in strengthening institutional ownership, sustaining political commitment, and enabling measurable progress on gender equality outcomes.
- ▶ **Sequencing complementary policies can shift gender equality from a social issue to an economic governance priority.** The parallel approval of the Women's Economic Empowerment Policy and the National Care Policy demonstrated that addressing market access and unpaid care together creates a stronger policy proposition than advancing either in isolation. This sequencing reframed women's economic participation as a systemic economic issue rather than a sectoral social concern, strengthened political buy-in across economic and planning institutions, and increased the likelihood that gender equality commitments translate into financing, implementation and accountability.
- ▶ **Sustained donor engagement combined with early integration of gender equality and government ownership at the design stage is critical to embedding gender transformative approaches across the full Joint Programme cycle.** Experience shows that when gender equality objectives are anchored early within the UNSDCF and Joint Programme design, reinforced through continuous donor engagement, and co-owned by national and county governments from inception, agencies demonstrate stronger commitment to gender transformative programming throughout implementation, monitoring and reporting, and Joint Programmes achieve deeper institutional traction and subnational presence.
- ▶ **Integrating economic empowerment within GBV prevention and response strengthens survivor agency and long-term resilience.** Experience shows that combining psychosocial and legal support with financial literacy and livelihood assistance reduces survivors' economic dependence on perpetrators, strengthens decision-making power, and supports safer exit from abusive situations. Embedding economic empowerment as a core component of GBV programming enhances recovery outcomes and sustainability beyond immediate protection services.

UN Women Kenya Financial Report 2025



Thank you to our Partners and Donors





Photo: UN Women/Kenya

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